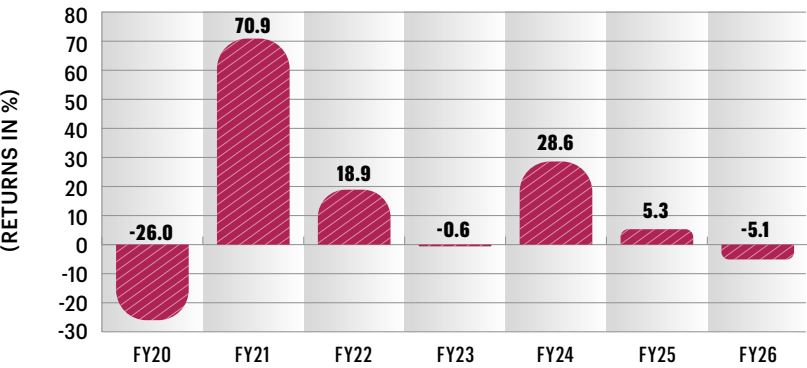


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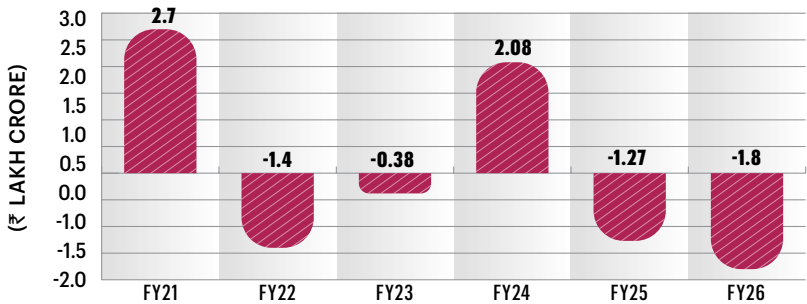
• The Nifty 50 was the worst performer among 15 major global indices in FY26



SOURCE ACE EQUITY

NO LET-UP IN FPI OUTFLOWS

• Foreign investors have been net sellers in four out of last five years



SOURCE NSDL

TOP MUTUAL FUNDS

• Nippon tops in two categories over a five-year period

FUND	5-YEAR TRAILING RETURNS	CATEGORY
► Nippon India Large Cap Fund-Direct Plan - Growth Plan	18.64%	Large-Cap
► Motilal Oswal Midcap 30 Direct Growth	25.22%	Mid-Cap
► Bandhan Emerging Businesses Fund Direct Growth	25.15%	Small-Cap
► HDFC Flexi Cap Fund-Direct Plan-Growth Option	21.21%	Flexi Cap
► Nippon India Multi Cap Fund-Direct Plan - Growth	22.60%	Multi-Cap

AS ON APRIL 17, SOURCE BUSINESSSTODAY.IN

mobility and cleaner energy.

At the same time, he cautions against sectors vulnerable to crude price shocks, including oil marketing companies and businesses dependent on petrochemicals such as chemicals, plastics, and fertilisers.

MUTUAL FUND PLAYBOOK

For investors, discipline remains the key. Equity allocations should be staggered and remain at neutral levels. Large- and mid-cap funds are expected to outperform small-cap funds over the next 18–24 months. Key themes are banking, health-care, and consumer discretionary. Diversification is equally important. Investors should also consider exposure to alternative investment funds, structured investment products, and global equities.

As investors fine-tune their mutual fund portfolios for FY27, the focus should not only be on asset allocation but also identifying which sectors and themes are likely to lead or lag in the evolving market environment. “Domestic-oriented sectors appear better placed, particularly discretionary consumption such as passenger vehicles, jewellery retail and hospitals, where underlying demand continues to hold up well. Cement also looks good with improving volumes and pricing support. Renewable energy remains an attractive structural theme,” says Feroze Azeez, Joint CEO, Anand Rathi Wealth.

“Within financials, the tilt is towards PSBs over larger private banks, and towards banks over NBFCs, given the relative comfort on asset quality and growth visibility. In IT, the absence of negative surprises provides comfort, with large-caps appearing more reasonable on valuations. Real estate, FMCG and export-oriented chemicals may face near-term headwinds and underperform,” he says.